

Jothi Teaching Standards

TEACHING ENVIRONMENT AND TECHNOLOGY STANDARD

Operational standard for creating a reliable, clear, and instructionally effective teaching setup in online lessons

Author	Prakash Micheal — Johti Learning, United Kingdom
Document ID	JTS05 — Version 2.0
Publication Date	April 2026
Status	Current — supersedes JTS05 v1.0 (March 2026)
Intended Audience	Tutors, mentors, and academy leadership
Related Documents	JTS01 v2.0, JTS02 v2.0, JTD01 v2.0, JTD04 v2.0

1. Purpose

At Johti, every lesson is delivered online. The teaching environment is not a background issue — it directly affects whether explanation is followable, student participation is possible, and teaching quality can be maintained. Technical failure is not a minor inconvenience; it disrupts the 4T cycle and reduces learning time.

This standard defines the minimum technical requirements and environment expectations for every Johti lesson. Linked competency: F2 (Professional Reliability and Readiness). Technical preparation is part of professional reliability — it is not optional.

2. Technology Requirements

Requirement	Standard	Failure Impact
Device	A computer or tablet capable of handling video communication, screen sharing, digital writing, and lesson resources simultaneously — without lag or repeated instability.	Frequent freezing, slow switching, or crashes break lesson flow and reduce the time available for teaching.
Internet connection	A stable, wired or strong Wi-Fi connection capable of supporting clear audio, stable screen sharing, and Zoom without repeated drops.	Reconnection interruptions break the teaching cycle at exactly the moments when it is most important — mid-explanation or mid-correction.

Requirement	Standard	Failure Impact
Digital writing device	A writing tablet, stylus-enabled screen, or equivalent that allows fluid, legible, real-time board writing. Mouse-drawn working is not acceptable for Johti teaching.	Illegible or slow board work undermines the Teach phase and removes the diagnostic opportunities described in JTS02 v2.0.
Microphone and audio	Clear, consistent audio. Speech audible without strain or distortion. Background noise minimised. No audio cutting in and out during explanation.	A lesson can survive without camera. It cannot survive poor audio. Inaudible explanation destroys instructional value.
Zoom setup	Logged in using the assigned Johti Gmail account before the lesson starts. Room ID confirmed. Recordings enabled where required. Attendance marked in Ayotree immediately after the lesson.	Late login or incorrect room setup delays the lesson start and signals poor preparation to the student and parent.
Board software	OneNote, GoodNotes, or equivalent digital board software set up and open before the lesson starts. Organised by student or topic so relevant content is accessible without switching delays.	Searching for files or setting up software during lesson time is dead time and signals lack of preparation.
Classkick	Relevant assignment prepared and accessible before the lesson. Students directed to the correct assignment at the right point in the lesson. Tutor monitoring student work through the Classkick dashboard.	Classkick that is set up during the lesson, or not used at all, removes the Track phase's primary visibility tool for group teaching.

3. Physical Environment Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Quiet space	Teach from a location free from background noise — voices, music, traffic, household activity. Intermittent noise is acceptable; persistent noise is not.
Adequate lighting	If camera is used, the tutor should be clearly visible without harsh shadows or backlighting. If camera is not used, lighting for the board must be adequate.
Professional background	The background visible on camera should be neutral and professional. Personal or distracting backgrounds should use Zoom's virtual background feature.
Freedom from interruption	The teaching space should be free from physical interruptions during the lesson. This is a safeguarding and professional requirement as well as a teaching quality one.

4. Pre-Lesson Checklist

Every tutor must complete the following checks before each lesson. These are not optional — they are the minimum preparation required to begin a Johti lesson.

	Check	If Not Ready
1	Internet connection stable and tested	Switch to mobile data backup or reschedule if connection is unreliable. Do not start a lesson on an unstable connection.
2	Zoom logged in with correct Johti Gmail account, correct room confirmed	Log in before the lesson start time — not when the student is waiting.
3	Microphone tested and clear	Use a headset if background noise is a risk. Do not start the lesson with untested audio.
4	Writing tablet or stylus functioning correctly	Test before the lesson. A failed tablet mid-explanation cannot be replaced in real time.
5	Board software open with relevant student notes or working space ready	Set up before the lesson. Searching for files during the lesson is preparation that should have happened earlier.
6	Classkick assignment prepared and ready to share	Set up in advance. Do not configure Classkick while the student waits.
7	Ayotree checked — lesson confirmed, student details visible	Check Ayotree before the lesson starts. If attendance cannot be marked correctly, resolve with admin before the session ends.
8	School context checked — upcoming topics or tests noted	If not checked in advance, ask the student at the start of the lesson. This is A4 Curriculum Awareness — it must happen.

5. Screen Layout During Lessons

The tutor's screen should be organised so the lesson flows without technical delay.

- Keep the board visible and full-screen when teaching. Do not let notification windows appear over board working.
- Have lesson materials accessible in one click or tab switch — not buried in folders.
- Keep Classkick visible in a second window or on a second screen where possible.
- Minimise unnecessary windows. Context-switching during explanation breaks lesson flow and signals poor preparation.

Tutors with access to dual screens should use one for the board and one for student monitoring (Classkick, Zoom gallery view). The Zoom dual screen setting supports this.

6. Zoom Recordings and Safeguarding

All Johti lessons are recorded through Zoom. The following apply.

- Recordings are kept for 30 days and then automatically deleted.
- Parents and students must raise any concerns within 14 days, in line with Johti's safeguarding communication timeline.

- Tutors must teach as if every lesson is being reviewed. Professional conduct must be consistent — not performed only when observed.
- Tutors must not download or share recordings without authorisation. Any sharing of recordings is subject to Johti's data and safeguarding policies.
- AI-generated summaries from Zoom may be used by mentors to support lesson review where appropriate.

7. Common Environment and Technology Errors

Error	Instructional and Professional Impact
Late login or delayed start	Wastes lesson time and signals to the student and parent that the tutor is not prepared. Punctuality is F2.
Poor audio quality	Inaudible or distorted explanation destroys the Teach phase. No other compensating behaviour can recover it.
Unreliable or slow writing device	Slow, jerky, or illegible board writing undermines explanation quality and weakens diagnostic opportunities.
Setting up during the lesson	Configuring Zoom, Classkick, or board software while the student waits is time that should have been used for preparation.
Teaching from a noisy environment	Persistent background noise distracts the student, reduces audio clarity, and creates a non-professional impression.
Forgetting to mark Ayotree attendance	Attendance records are required for payroll, safeguarding, and operational accuracy. Omitting them is an F2 failure.

8. What Mentors Observe

When reviewing teaching environment and technology, mentors assess whether the setup supports — or obstructs — the quality of teaching. The question is not 'Is the technology present?' It is 'Does the setup allow the 4T cycle to function effectively?'

- Audio is clear and consistent throughout the lesson.
- Board writing is legible, well-paced, and structurally clear — linked to JTS02 v2.0.
- Screen layout supports smooth lesson transitions without visible searching or setup delays.
- Classkick or equivalent is being used to track student thinking in group lessons.
- The environment is professional — quiet, appropriately lit, free from interruption.
- Lesson begins on time. Ayotree is marked at the end.

9. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Technology requirements presented as a table with failure impact column	v1.0 described each requirement in prose. The failure impact column makes clear why each matters — turning requirements into understanding rather than a checklist.
Pre-lesson checklist table added	New in v2.0. v1.0 described pre-lesson preparation in general terms. v2.0 gives a specific eight-point checklist with a response for each failure case.
Zoom recordings and safeguarding section added	New in v2.0. Zoom recording policy, the 30-day retention timeline, and the safeguarding link needed to be explicit in one place.
F2 competency code linked throughout	All references now use the A-F taxonomy from JTD01 v2.0. Technical preparation is explicitly framed as a component of F2 Professional Reliability.
Lengthy rationale sections removed	v1.0 included extended explanations of why each technical element matters pedagogically. These belong in the SKOOL course, not in an operational standard. v2.0 states requirements and moves on.
A4 curriculum check added to pre-lesson checklist	A4 Curriculum and School Alignment Awareness requires checking school context before lesson content is decided. This is now explicitly in the pre-lesson preparation list.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

JTS05 v2.0 — April 2026